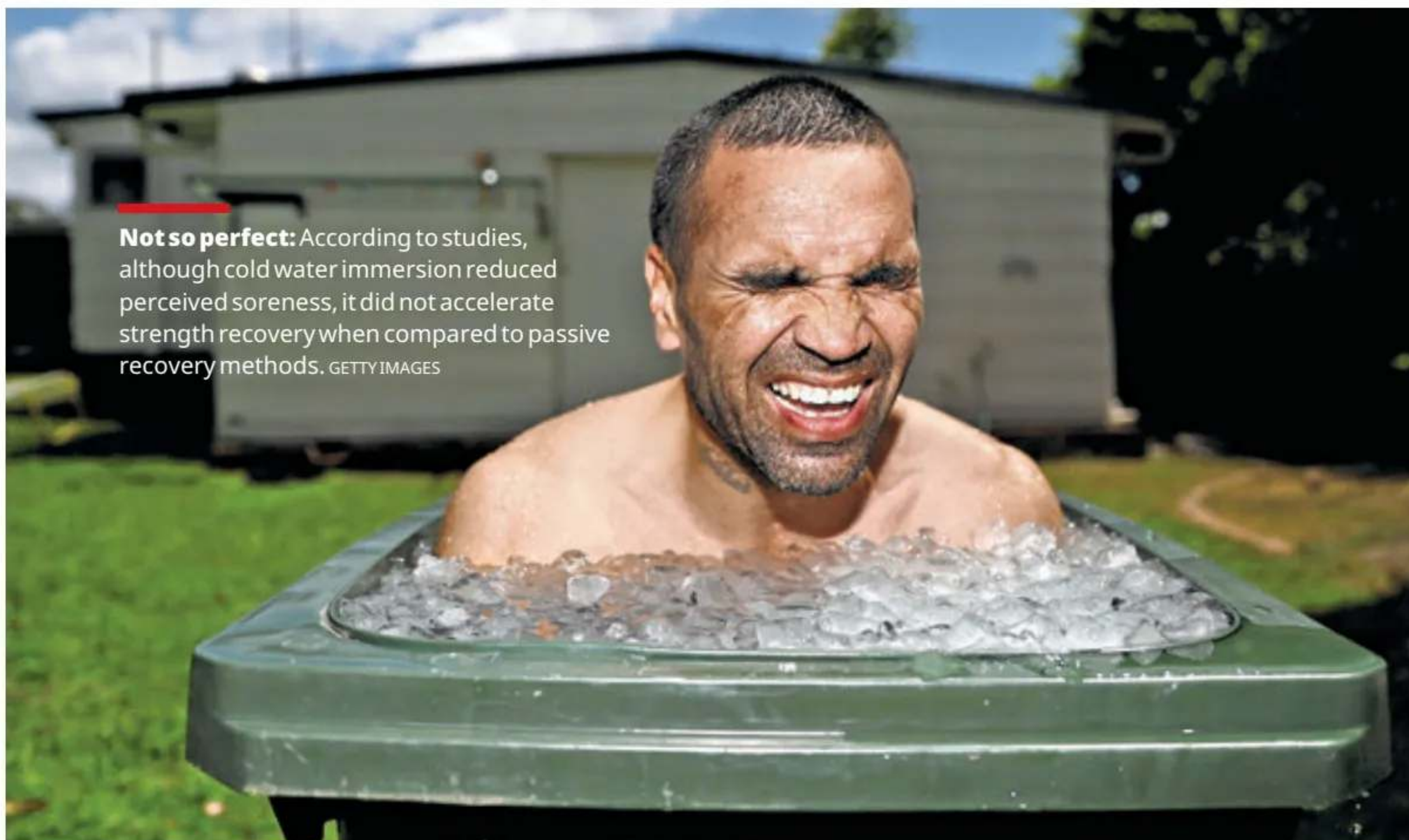




Not so perfect: According to studies, although cold water immersion reduced perceived soreness, it did not accelerate strength recovery when compared to passive recovery methods. GETTY IMAGES

volume, indicating enhanced recovery and hydration status.

Moreover, a systematic review published in the International Journal of Sports Medicine analysed the effects of sauna bathing on athletic performance and recovery. The review concluded that sauna bathing had positive effects on cardiovascular function, thermoregulation, and hormonal response, all of which contribute to improved recovery and performance.

Advantages of sauna therapy

Sauna therapy offers several advantages over cold therapy, including:

1. Enhanced circulation: Sauna therapy promotes vasodilation, leading to increased blood flow and nutrient delivery to muscles, which aids in recovery and repair.

2. Hormonal response: Sauna bathing stimulates the release of endorphins, growth hormone, and heat shock proteins, which play crucial roles in muscle repair, adaptation, and stress reduction.

3. Improved cardiovascular function: Regular sauna use has been shown to improve



Better alternative?: Sauna therapy is said to help develop enhanced cardiovascular function, improved endurance, and better recovery.

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cardiovascular health, including reduced risk of hypertension, lower cholesterol levels, and improved endothelial function.

4. Relaxation and stress relief:

Sauna bathing induces a state of relaxation and promotes stress relief, which is essential for recovery and overall well-being.

While cold therapy has been a popular recovery modality among athletes and fitness enthusiasts, scientific evidence suggests that sauna therapy may offer superior benefits in terms of recovery, performance enhancement, and overall health.

Sauna therapy's ability to improve circulation, stimulate hormonal response, and promote relaxation makes it a more effective option for post-workout recovery.

As research continues to unveil the therapeutic properties of sauna bathing, it's time to reconsider its place as the ultimate recovery tool in the fitness arsenal.



Saunas induce sweating, increase heart rate, and promote vasodilation, leading to improved blood flow and circulation.